

HAVENBAY PROCESS CANON

Verbatim extract from [SAS/ally-quinn-bible.md](#), sections 2.3.1 to 2.3.2. Includes the Tip Line ruling and R16, both Stephen-ruled 2026-08-26.

2.3.1 Havenbay recording law (Stephen-ruled 2026-08-24)

Havenbay is an **all-party consent** jurisdiction, and the rule has two separate limbs, which is where the drama lives.

Making a recording. Recording a private conversation without the consent of every party is an offence, **except** where the recording is reasonably necessary to protect the lawful interests of the person making it, or to preserve evidence of a serious offence.

Publishing a recording. Communicating or publishing such a recording is a **separate and stricter** offence. Narrow exceptions only: disclosure to police, use in legal proceedings, or the consent of the parties recorded.

What this means in practice, and why it was ruled this way rather than as one-party consent.

- **Gerald's recording of Frank Doyle is lawful to make and unlawful to broadcast.** He is a retired detective who reasonably believed a homicide was being disclosed by a man who would deny it by morning. He was right; Doyle was dead by breakfast. The exception fits, so Gerald stays competent, which a flat prohibition would not have allowed.
- **Airing a tape is a sacrifice, never a tactic.** Ally broadcasting it commits an offence in public and on the record, and exposes whoever made the recording. Any episode branch built on publication must price that in.
- **There is a lawful quiet route.** Disclosure to police is an exception, so Ally can play a recording to Del privately. The quiet path has a mechanism of its own rather than being merely the absence of the loud one.
- **The Tip Line is unaffected.** A caller who rings a line and leaves a message consents by the act. This is why the Tip Line works as an object-character and why the archive is lawful.
- **Ally asks before she records an interview, on microphone.** It is real podcast practice, it demonstrates evidential discipline without a speech about it, and it makes any covert recording she does make a decision with a price rather than a free tool.

Exposition budget: the player never needs the statute. One line from Del at the moment of choosing carries it. Register: *you can play me that, you can't play it to Havenbay.*

Note: this is chosen worldbuilding, not researched law. It follows the recognisable shape of all-party-consent regimes so a player finds it credible. Havenbay is fictional and the rule is ours to set; the constraint is only that it must not grant anyone a power institutions do not plausibly have.

2.3.1b The Tip Line, what it is for (Stephen-ruled 2026-08-26)

The Tip Line is the voice of the city dwellers who wish to stay anonymous for now. It is an approved, standing plot device and is not restricted to any one episode. A caller consents by leaving a message,

so making the recording is lawful under §2.3.1; publishing any part of it is a separate question and is Ally's to answer each time.

Effect: the line is a signature of the show rather than a liability inherited from the demoted Episode 1. Concerns that reusing it repeats The Listener are resolved: the device is fine, and what failed there was the absence of jeopardy, not the telephone.

The standing constraint that makes it dramatic: the line keeps a voice, a date and a time, and no caller metadata, because that promise is the only reason anyone uses it. An anonymous caller who is cut off cannot be called back.

2.3.2 Havenbay institutional processes (Stephen-ruled 2026-08-25)

Fifteen parameters, ruled in one sitting to close the gap that killed roughly a third of two premise fields. **These are parameters, not powers.** Kill Gate Zero is untouched: nobody may invent an authority an institution does not have. What is settled here is how long Havenbay's institutions keep things and who may ask for them.

Records and retention

#	Ruling
R1	Sample handling records outlive the samples. Toxicology and pathology samples are destroyed on schedule; the register of who handled them is kept twenty-five years and is disclosable to next of kin.
R2	Weather and visibility observations are permanent and publicly searchable.
R4	A wound-up company's records pass to the liquidator, then to whoever buys the assets, and are retained seven years after dissolution . Nothing is destroyed inside that window.
R7	CCTV is kept thirty-one days , and indefinitely once flagged for an investigation.
R8	Ordinary commercial operational data — dispatch, tracking, transaction logs — is kept seven years .
R12	Fire investigation reports are retained twenty years . Findings go to the coroner, the property owner and the insurer. Working notes are not disclosable.

Who may obtain what

#	Ruling
R3	Harbour authority contracts and payments are a public register , searchable, retained seven years.
R5	Coronial files: next of kin may obtain the findings and the evidence tendered. Police running sheets, working notes and unused material stay closed.
R6	Inquest and court transcripts may be ordered by anyone on payment of a fee, unless a court restricts them.
R9	A report commissioned by an insurer belongs to the insurer. Where prepared in contemplation of a claim dispute it is privileged, and the investigator who wrote it may not release it unilaterally.
R10	A deceased person's medical records may be obtained by next of kin or an executor, with third-party information redacted. Never by Ally in her own right.
R11	Death certificates are restricted to next of kin, executors and legal representatives for thirty years , then open to public search.
R14	Council permits, planning records and property transfers are publicly searchable, permanently.
R15	Vehicle event data belongs to the vehicle owner; an insurer may hold a copy under the policy; police seizure removes all other access.

Investigation

#	Ruling
R13	A workplace fatality is investigated by the regulator. The site is preserved until released. The report goes to next of kin and to the coroner.

The consistent line across R5, R9 and R12: a filed finding is reachable, an investigator's working notes are not. Hold that line in every institution or the world stops being credible.

What these rulings cost, recorded so nobody re-litigates them. R8 confirms a 2001 dispatch record no longer exists. R9 removes the access route from a premise built on a retired investigator handing over an insurer's report. R11 breaks an access claim that assumed recent death certificates were freely searchable. R15 keeps event data on a seized vehicle out of reach. **Four premises died to keep the other eleven rulings honest.**

Standing effect. A seed previously failed for want of one of these rulings may be resubmitted **once**, under the normal gates. Future premises depending on any process above no longer require research: they cite the ruling.

Standing practice, and the reason this section exists. Prompt kit v2.1 never said an unverified process was fatal. It says *identify the required Havenbay canon ruling and fail the seed pending approval*. Across roughly fifty seeds in two executions, neither model ever returned one for a ruling; both read a question queue

as a wall. **Where a premise depends on a Havenbay process that is not yet settled, ask for the ruling. Do not kill the seed and do not invent the answer.**

2.4 The Rusty Anchor

The bar is as much a character as any person in Ally's world. Founded **1924** by **Patrick Callahan** as *Callahan's Dockside* (a "soda shop" front through Prohibition); renamed **The Rusty Anchor** in the 1970s by his son **Seamus**, after the salvaged shipwreck anchor now bolted by the door under a battered green neon sign; inherited in the 2000s by Seamus's daughter **Moira "Mo" Callahan**, who keeps it what it has always been: **neutral ground**. Cops and crooks drink under the same roof; city officials slip in for a whisky away from prying eyes; violence goes outside, whoever you are — and because everyone trusts the rule, Mo hears everything.

Geography of the room: ~60 seats — twenty stools, eight booths, six tables — plus a rear courtyard with an acoustic stage. **Gerald's booth** (the corner booth, held for him without asking) is the series' warmest set and an unofficial confessional; Mo's locked upstairs office holds "ledgers, old matchbooks, and a shoebox of favors owed." House fare: shepherd's pie, fish and chips in newsprint, the chowder of the day, Callahan's Stout, Dockhand's Whiskey, and the signature **Anchor Drop** (dark rum, ginger beer, lime, bitters). Thomas Quinn met sources here; Gerald calls it his second home; the Rusty Anchor item family (Chapter 7) makes the player buy their rounds like everyone else. **Mo's Back Room** (ruled 2026-08-07): the Anchor's quiet trading post behind the bar and the game's CaseCash shop — "Neutral ground. Fair prices. No questions." Daily stock, delivered to the Stash; Mo asks nothing about where the cash came from.

2.5 Episode 1 geography (locked)

The Listener made a corridor of the city canon: **Rivermouth** (Chandler Road, the school bell at 8:30 and noon, the swing-bridge's 22-second counterweight note, the blue-gated cottage, Mrs. Vale's doorbell camera next door) → the river reach where the **quiet boats** run dark (low in the water going out, riding high coming back; cash mooring fees, no manifests) → the **allotments** and the first morning bus → **Larkhill** (Chapel Lane, the church, the hill fog, Vera's cottage, St. Brigid's Pharmacy). Scripts set on this ground must respect these facts; the swing-bridge note and the school bells are now diegetic timekeepers any future Rivermouth scene can reuse.

2.6 Culture & texture

Food: chowders, pier dumplings, 2 a.m. diners, lumpia stands, Irish pubs — and the Kestrel Corner Diner, whose takeout boxes open Rivermouth's doors (Episode 1). Fashion: dock coats and flannel below, tailored trench-coat money above; noir silhouettes echo the genre on purpose. Sports: the **Havenbay Mariners** (baseball), the **Bay City Sharks** (hockey — games often end in bar fights), and amateur boxing under Frankie Malone's promotion. Art: "rebellion and code" — Nova's murals on the Viaduct, Highcliff galleries fronting quiet money. Tech: "a city caught between analog grit and digital intrusion" — half-working fingerprint scanners and sabotaged CCTV two streets from gleaming corporate data centers. Faith: churches as community anchors rather than political powers; a parish newsletter can still find a missing woman (Episode 1).

Havenbay's contrasts are the story engine: wealth against poverty, tradition against progress, public virtue against private vice. Its warmth is real — and so are the shadows it casts.

Chapter 3 — The Season Arc

The season question: **who killed Thomas Quinn, and what conspiracy was he uncovering?** Every episode is a self-contained case plus exactly one new arc clue — one new fact, one new cost, never the full answer — until the finale unmasks the Ferryman and Councillor Hart live on the podcast. "The personal quest to solve her father's murder is the key that unlocks the city's deepest conspiracy."

R16. Cross-jurisdictional matching of missing-person reports against unidentified deceased (Stephen-ruled 2026-08-26).

Participation is VOLUNTARY AND PATCHY. Havenbay and the other jurisdictions contribute to a shared comparison system, but entry is not mandated, coverage is incomplete, and practice varies by agency and by the classification a case is given.

Why it reads true: this is the real-world norm rather than a convenience. In the United States only around sixteen or seventeen states mandate entry into the national system, and in ninety per cent of counties not a single active unclaimed-person case was listed over a five-year period. In Australia roughly seven hundred and fifty sets of unidentified human remains are held nationally, and a dedicated national DNA programme had to be created to go back and ask families to voluntarily provide reference samples that were never taken at the time of report.

Consequences that are now canon: - **Entry is not identification.** A description match returns a candidate list. Resolving it requires biometrics or a family follow-up. - **A low-risk or voluntarily-absent classification does not attract reference-sample collection**, because nobody believes the person is dead. This is the most common reason a body and a report never meet, and it requires no professional to omit a step. - Fingerprints identify only a person already on file. Odontology is confirmatory, not searching, and needs a named candidate first.

Recorded: Claude's **No Fixed Address** premise depends on this ruling, and the ruling was made after checking real-world practice rather than from what the premise needed. Had it gone the other way the premise would still stand on the absent reference sample alone.